

An abstract, grayscale illustration of a city skyline. It features various geometric shapes representing buildings, including rectangles, squares, and a prominent vertical structure with horizontal lines. The composition is layered, with some buildings appearing in front of others, creating a sense of depth. The background is a light gray, and the foreground elements are in darker shades of gray and black.

CNN News Channel: A Case Study

Navigating Digital Disruption and Trust Challenges in Modern Media

Name : Koushik

USN : NU23UCA052

Course : BCA - 3rd year / v sem

Program : Employability program

Session Flow

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1
Introduction

CNN's legacy and global footprint

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2
Digital Era Crisis

Streaming wars and CNN+ collapse

0

3
Credibility Crisis

Trust erosion and leadership upheaval

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4
Strategic Analysis

Management response assessment

0

5
Recommendations

Path forward for brand revival

Cable News Network: Origins and Evolution

Foundation

- Launched June 1980 by Ted Turner
- First 24-hour television news network
- Revolutionised real-time global news coverage

Ownership

Structure

Warner Bros. Discovery (2022 merger)

Previously: WarnerMedia, Time Warner, Turner Broadcasting



Traditional Strengths and Market Position



Breaking News Authority

Gulf War coverage established 24/7 credibility
Airport presence in 58 US airports

International Network

36 bureaus globally
CNN International reaches 200+ territories

Brand Recognition

89% aided awareness in US households
Trusted source for major events

Conclusion

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Crisis One: Digital Era

Disruption The Perfect Storm of Streaming and Cord-Cutting

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Audience

Fragmentation

Traditional cable subscribers declined
25% (2015-2023)

Younger demographics migrated to
social platforms

2

Revenue Pressure

Advertising revenue dropped 30%
year-over-year

Cable affiliate fees under threat from
cord-cutting

3

Competition

Intensifies

Digital-native outlets: Vice, BuzzFeed,
Vox

Social media became primary news
source for Gen Z

The CNN+

Debacle

Launch:

March 2022

\$300 million investment

Subscription model: \$5.99/month

Shutdown:

April 2022

Lasted only 32 days

150,000 subscribers acquired

Massive strategic failure

Conclusion

References

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Crisis Two: Brand Credibility Under Siege



Talent Exodus

Jim Acosta demoted, Chris Cuomo terminated

Don Lemon, Brian Stelter departed

Leadership churn: 3 CEOs in 18 months

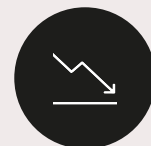


Legal Troubles

Defamation lawsuits from public figures

Project Veritas settlement controversy

Fact-checking accuracy questioned



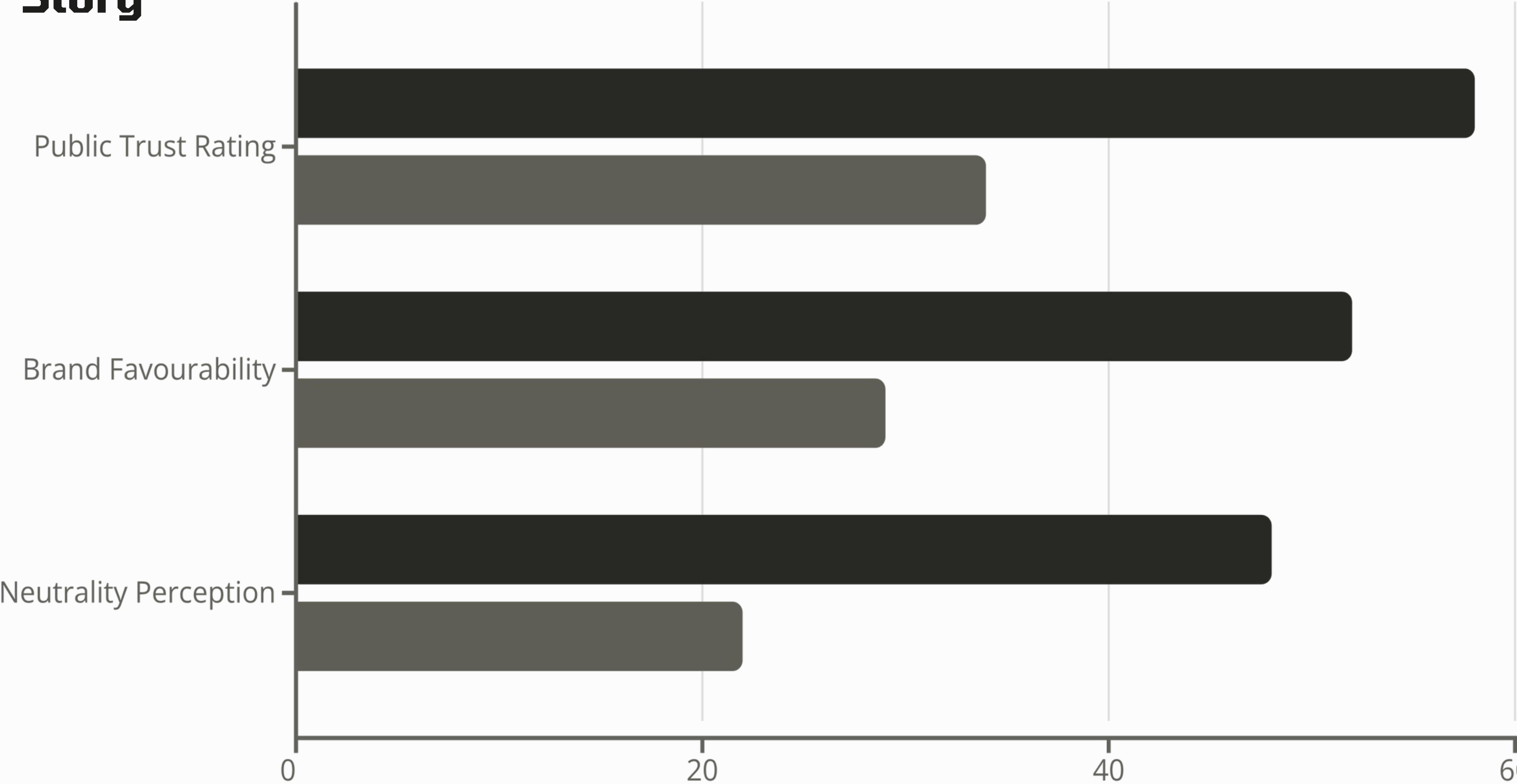
Ratings Collapse

Prime-time viewership down 60% (2021-2023)

Lost neutrality perception to competitors

Social media backlash intensified

Trust Metrics: The Numbers Tell the Story



Strategic Analysis and Recommendations

Digital Innovation

- Invest in AI-driven personalised content
- Build mobile-first, not TV-first experiences
- Partner with TikTok, Instagram for Gen Z reach
- Develop interactive, immersive journalism formats

Trust Rebuilding

- Establish independent editorial oversight board
- Transparent corrections policy prominently displayed
- Diversify on-air talent and perspectives
- Reduce opinion programming, increase reporting

Business Model

- Revenue:** ads, subscriptions, events, licensing
- Niche vertical strategies (health, finance, tech news)
 - Global expansion in emerging markets
 - Premium investigative journalism subscription tier



Conclusion

CNN's case study highlights critical lessons in navigating digital disruption and trust challenges within the modern media landscape, emphasizing the urgent need for innovation and strategic adaptation to maintain relevance and credibility

References

Pew Research Center (2023), Nielsen Media Research, Columbia Journalism Review, Variety Industry Reports, Warner Bros. Discovery Financial Filings (2022-2024) Google , Wikipedia , Relief web ,

*Thank
You*